TRADINGBIBLE HOLDINGS, INC.

CONTROLLED TEMPLATE · COUNSEL REVIEW REQUIRED

Payroll and Benefits Framework

PAYROLL-BENEFITS · VERSION 1.0 · 12 NOVEMBER 2026

CONTROLLED TEMPLATE · COUNSEL REVIEW AND LOCAL ADOPTION REQUIRED. This document is a company policy or contract framework, not an executed agreement, a legal opinion, a regulatory approval, a payroll filing, an insurance policy or a promise of a benefit. Record adoption and approval references in the Workforce Compliance Register before treating it as operative.

TRADINGBIBLE HOLDINGS, INC. — PAYROLL AND BENEFITS FRAMEWORK

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> ***Controlled template — CFO, payroll, tax and local counsel review required.*** *This framework describes how the company should administer pay and benefits. It is not a payroll filing, a benefit plan, an insurance policy or a promise of any benefit. Do not pay a salary, run a payroll, enrol an employee in a pension or promise equity until the lawful route and approvals are in place.*

1. Principles

1. Pay people accurately, on time and in the lawful currency.
2. Classify employees and contractors correctly under the work-location law.
3. Withhold, remit and file taxes and statutory contributions.
4. Keep payroll, benefit and tax records restricted and auditable.
5. Separate the person who calculates payroll from the person who approves it and the person who funds it.
6. Do not use platform credits, a proposed token or an informal transfer as a substitute for salary.
7. Do not promise a benefit, bonus, equity award or option unless the plan, board approval, tax analysis and local-law review are complete.
8. Apply the local addendum where it is more protective than this framework.

2. Classification and contracts

Before the first payroll run, the company must confirm:

- the employee's work country and state/region;
- the lawful employing entity or employer-of-record arrangement;
- employee or contractor status under the local classification test;
- the written contract or statement of particulars;
- the job description, salary band and approval;
- the pay frequency, currency and pay day;
- the tax, social-security, pension, insurance and workers' compensation registrations;
- the right-to-work and identity verification;
- the data-protection and record-retention requirements.

A contractor must not be treated as an employee for control purposes while being labelled a contractor for payroll. A full-time worker under the company's direction, schedule and equipment is normally an employee, regardless of the label.

3. Salary and pay

The company should maintain a salary register with the approved band, base salary, currency, pay frequency, effective date and approver for each employee. A salary change requires written approval and an updated payroll record.

Pay frequency and pay day must comply with local law and the contract. The company should issue a payslip or pay statement showing gross pay, deductions, net pay and any statutory employer contribution where required.

Overtime, shift premiums, commissions and bonuses must be calculated under a written policy or plan. Do not use a discretionary label to avoid a statutory entitlement. Do not promise a bonus that has not been approved.

4. Deductions and statutory contributions

The company may make only lawful deductions. Deductions for taxes, social security, pension, court orders, benefit contributions or a written employee authorisation must be documented. Unlawful deductions from final pay are prohibited.

United States

The company must:

- obtain and use the EIN for employment-tax administration;
- complete Form I-9 and retain the record;
- collect Form W-4 and applicable state withholding elections;
- withhold and remit federal income tax, Social Security and Medicare, and pay the employer share;
- handle federal unemployment tax and applicable state unemployment and disability programmes;
- follow minimum-wage, overtime, working-time and recordkeeping rules;
- provide required workplace notices;
- confirm state-specific paid leave, workers' compensation and disability requirements.

Nigeria

The company must, subject to current law and local counsel confirmation:

- operate PAYE deductions and remittances with the relevant tax authority;
- assess whether the company and employee are covered by the mandatory contributory pension regime and register where required;
- assess NSITF registration and the Employees' Compensation Scheme contribution;
- meet applicable workplace-safety and employee-compensation obligations;
- follow Nigerian leave, working-hours and termination rules;
- apply Nigerian data-protection requirements to payroll records.

The commonly stated pension reference for covered employees is 10% employer and 8% employee. That is not a conclusion for every worker or arrangement. Applicability and current rates must be confirmed before the first payroll run.

Other countries

Engage local payroll and counsel before the offer. Confirm the lawful entity, tax registrations, social security, pension, insurance, workers' compensation, leave, notice and data-protection rules. Do not use a US or Nigerian template by default.

5. Leave and absence

The company must apply the leave rules of the employee's work location, including annual leave, public holidays, sick leave, parental leave, bereavement leave, voting leave, military leave and any other statutory leave. The local addendum controls where it is more protective.

Leave records should show the entitlement, accrual, taken, remaining and any carried-over balance. Sick-leave records should be limited to what is necessary; medical details belong in a restricted file and should not be shared with the wider team.

6. Expenses and reimbursement

Employees must submit expenses with a receipt, business purpose, date, amount, currency and approver. The company should reimburse approved expenses within the stated period and in the lawful currency. Personal expenses, fines, unsupported costs and expenses that breach the travel or gifts policy are not reimbursable.

7. Final pay

On termination, the company must calculate:

- salary through the last day;
- accrued but unused leave under local law and the contract;
- earned commissions or bonus under the written plan;
- lawful deductions and statutory contributions;
- notice pay or pay in lieu where applicable;
- pension, insurance and benefit end dates;
- equity or option treatment under the plan documents, without inventing a vesting or exercise decision.

The final-pay calculation must be reviewed by a second authorised person and preserved in the payroll record. Follow the local timing and documentation rules.

8. Benefits framework

The following tiers are a **proposed framework**, not existing entitlements. No benefit exists until the board or an authorised officer approves it in writing, the plan documents or policy are adopted and the local-law, tax and insurance review is complete.

Benefit	Standard (proposed)	Professional (proposed)	Executive (proposed)
Competitive salary	Yes, subject to approved band	Yes, subject to approved band	Yes, subject to approved executive band

Benefit	Standard (proposed)	Professional (proposed)	Executive (proposed)
Statutory leave	Yes, as required locally	Yes, as required locally	Yes, as required locally
Work equipment	Company-approved device or approved personal-device arrangement	Company-issued device and approved peripherals	Company-issued device and approved peripherals
Training budget	Basic role and mandatory training	Enhanced role and leadership training	Enhanced executive development
Health insurance	Consider; confirm local requirements and cost	Yes, subject to local plan availability and approval	Yes, subject to local plan availability and approval
Pension/retirement	Where required by law	Where required by law	Where required by law
Performance bonus	Role-dependent; written plan required	Target-based; written plan required	Target-based; written plan required
Equity or stock options	Not automatic; approved plan required	Select roles; approved plan required	Selected executives; board and securities approval required
Professional memberships	Not included by default	Consider for approved roles	Consider for approved roles
Relocation support	Not included by default	Selected roles only	Selected roles only

Equity and options boundary

Any equity, option, phantom-equity or token-allocation programme requires:

- board and shareholder approval where required;
- a written plan and award agreement;
- a valuation and tax analysis;
- securities-law review and, where applicable, a filing or exemption;
- local employment and tax review;
- a clear vesting, exercise, leaver and change-of-control framework.

No employee may be told that an equity award, option or token allocation exists until the award document is signed and the plan is operative. A proposed TBC allocation is not salary, equity or a promise.

9. Payroll records

Keep the following records in a restricted payroll system:

- salary register and approved bands;
- employment contracts and changes;
- tax and withholding forms;
- payroll registers and payslips;
- tax filings and remittance evidence;
- pension and social-insurance contributions;

- benefit enrolments and deductions;
- expense approvals and reimbursements;
- leave balances and final-pay calculations;
- bank-payment confirmations;
- audit logs and approver records.

Do not store full bank details, tax identifiers or identity documents in a spreadsheet, chat or email. Use the payroll provider's secure channel and the controlled HR file.

10. Controls and segregation of duties

The company should separate:

- payroll preparation from payroll approval;
- payroll approval from payment release;
- employee-record maintenance from payroll processing;
- benefit enrolment from invoice approval;
- termination approval from final-pay release.

At least two authorised people should review a payroll run before payment. A change to a bank account, salary, bonus or benefit requires independent verification. A payment-change request received by email must be verified through a separate known channel.

11. Budget

The workforce budget should include:

- gross salary;
- employer payroll taxes and statutory contributions;
- pension and social-insurance contributions;
- health and workers' compensation insurance;
- equipment and software;
- recruitment and onboarding;
- training and development;
- travel and expenses;
- severance or notice costs;
- a contingency for currency and payroll-provider fees.

The budget is not a promise of a role or a benefit. Each hire requires an approved headcount, role and funding source.

12. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Board / authorised officer	Approves the workforce budget, executive pay and any equity or benefit plan
CFO / Finance	Owns the payroll budget, funding, controls and tax calendar
People Operations	Owns contracts, employee records, onboarding, leave and offboarding
Payroll provider	Calculates, withholds, files and pays under the company's instructions
General Counsel	Reviews contracts, classification, equity, termination and local-law issues
Manager	Confirms work, objectives, leave, expenses and performance; does not promise benefits
Employee	Provides accurate information, records time, follows policy and reports concerns

13. Payroll calendar

The company should maintain a payroll calendar with:

- pay periods and pay dates;
- input cut-off dates;
- approval dates;
- funding dates;
- tax and pension remittance dates;
- filing deadlines;
- bank-holiday adjustments;
- a named owner and backup.

A missed or late payroll must be escalated to the CFO and People Operations immediately. Do not make a partial-silent payment or hide a shortfall.

14. Review and adoption

This framework must be reviewed by the CFO, People Operations and local counsel. Adoption must be recorded in the Workforce Compliance Register with the approving body, date and reference. A file existing in the document pack is not evidence of adoption.

Approved by: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Board / counsel reference: _____

> *The company does not create a payroll registration, tax filing, pension enrolment, insurance policy or benefit entitlement by recording a status in the compliance register. The underlying approval and provider record must exist.*